General rule – concentration · "Spells" chapter of SRD 5.2.1

Some spells require **Concentration** to remain active. You can concentrate on **one spell at a time**. Casting another Concentration spell ends the first.

You **lose** Concentration if you cast another Concentration spell, if you **take damage** and fail a Constitution save, or if you are **Incapacitated** or dead. You can also stop at any time (no action).

🎲 Quick summary:

1. Only one Concentration spell at a time.
2. Damage taken: **Constitution** save, DC 10 or half the damage (max DC 30).
3. Incapacitated or dead: Concentration lost.
4. Casting a **non**-Concentration spell doesn't break it.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 clarifies that casting a non-Concentration spell **doesn't end** Concentration, and that stopping needs no action.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The text doesn't say how to handle simultaneous damage. Fix: one save per **source** of damage.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the loss as a thread snapping: the magic vanishes at once.

Step 1 – Cast the spell:

If a spell needs Concentration, it says so in its duration ("Concentration, up to 1 minute").

Step 2 – Replace the old one:

If you were already concentrating, that spell ends immediately.

Step 3 – Take damage:

For each source of damage, make a **Constitution save**, DC 10 or half the damage taken (whichever is higher, max 30).

Step 4 – Other threats:

The DM may call for a save for an event (storm, shaking); they set the DC.

Step 5 – Ending:

Failing the save, being Incapacitated or dying ends the spell. You can also stop at will.

Example: Elora concentrates on Bless. An orc deals 14 damage: DC 10 vs half (7): DC 10. She rolls 13 on the d20 + bonus: success, the spell continues.

⚠ Common questions:

Can I cast two Concentration spells?

No: the second ends the first.

What is the DC?

10 or half the damage taken, whichever is higher, capped at 30.

Several attacks in one turn?

One save per source of damage.

Does healing break Concentration?

No: only damage and conditions count.

Can I stop voluntarily?

Yes, at any time, with no action.

Is a non-Concentration spell compatible?

Yes: casting Shield or Magic Missile doesn't break it.

What if I'm Unconscious?

Concentration ends.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Multiple sources of damage

One hit with several damage rolls: one save. **Option**: keep one save per separate damage roll.

Zero damage

No damage, no save. **Option**: keep it.

Area spells

If several creatures concentrate, each makes their own save. **Option**: keep it.

Non-damage disruption

A noise, a slip: the DM may ask for a save. **Option**: DC 10.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Bonus Action

A Concentration spell cast as a Bonus Action replaces the current one immediately.

Allies' damage

Only damage you take counts, not damage dealt to your allies.

Ritual

A Concentration ritual counts as a Concentration spell.

Maximum duration

The duration is a cap: you can always stop earlier.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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